Responsible Administrator: Provost
Responsible Office: Registrar
Effective Date: 08/6/2024
Approved by: President
Date Reviewed (no substantive changes): 03/19/2025

Commencement Regalia Adornment Policy

Policy Statement

As an official function of the University, commencement and graduate hooding ceremonies convey the scholarly tradition and formal tone befitting of an academic ceremony. As such, all faculty and graduating students participating in commencement ceremonies and graduate hooding ceremonies will wear traditional academic regalia - gown, cap, tassel and, if appropriate to degree, a hood representative of the highest degree they hold/will be receiving. Regalia may also include adornments associated with academic accomplishments and/or achievements, awards, associations or memberships, as long as the adornments have been approved by the University.

Ceremony participants not in compliance with the requirements of this policy may be asked to remove or conceal any unapproved regalia adornments.

Purpose of Policy

This policy sets forth standards related to the academic regalia worn at commencement and graduate hooding ceremonies, as well as the process by which University-approved organizations and programs may seek approval to add adornment to the regalia to signify membership or association. Adornments include any addition to the issued traditional academic regalia and may include, but are not limited to: cords, stoles, medallions, pins, zipper pulls, tassel décor, patches and other decorations.

Applicability

This policy applies to the regalia and adornments worn by faculty, staff and students participating in any University undergraduate/graduate commencement and graduate hooding ceremonies.

Policy Procedure

The official listing of University-approved regalia adornments is maintained by the Office of the Registrar and published on the Commencement webpage. The listing includes the requesting person or organization, description, and meaning of the adornment. Requests for approval of new adornments or updates to previously approved adornments are proposed using the **Commencement Regalia Adornment Request Form**. Only University approved programs and recognized student organizations (as registered with the Division of Student Affairs) may submit a request. Forms must be submitted by June 1 for Winter Commencement and November 1 for Spring Commencement.

The Commencement Committee will review proposals for duplication of existing organization regalia adornments, consistency with similar organizations, and potential for disruption to ceremonies. After review, a recommendation in support of or opposition to the proposal will be made to the Registrar. If the Registrar disagrees with the committee's recommendation, the Provost will render a final decision. The Registrar will communicate the final decision to the person/organization submitting the form, and update the official listing of approved adornments, if appropriate.

[End of Policy]